

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

MODERN ENGLISH (891)

PAPER 1 (Theory)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for **only** reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **four** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. You are advised to spend not more than 45 minutes on Question 1, 55 minutes on Question 2, 30 minutes on Question 3 and 50 minutes on Question 4.
7. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Question 4, you are required to write only **one** option as the answer.
8. You should begin each answer on a fresh page.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

1. Kindly read aloud the Instructions given on page 1 to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

Question 1

Write a composition (in approximately 400 – 450 words) on any **one** of the following subjects.
(You are reminded that you will be rewarded for the orderly and coherent presentation of [20]
the matter, use of appropriate style and general accuracy of spelling, punctuation and
grammar.)

- (i) You spent a few days at your grandparents' village during the harvest festival. Describe the fields, the fair, the food and the music, and the people you met there. Describe how you felt when you returned to the city.
- (ii) In a group project at school, one member of your team refused to do his share of the work. Narrate how you handled the situation and what the outcome was.
- (iii) Board examinations should be abolished. Argue either FOR or AGAINST the given statement.
- (iv) Home.
- (v) Comparison is the thief of joy. Present your reflections on this statement.
- (vi) Write an original short story that ends with the words: '...She folded the note carefully and smiled; some secrets were worth keeping.'

Question 2

- (i) You are the editor of your school magazine. Write a feature article in about 250 – 300 words for its next issue, titled **Screen Time and the Teenage Mind**, based on the following guidelines: [15]
- how much time teenagers spend on screens – the effects on sleep and concentration – the effects on family relationships and friendships – social media and self-image – ways to strike a balance – the role of parents and schools
- (ii) As the Secretary of the Computer Club of your school, you wish to organise a cyber-safety awareness workshop for students of Classes VI to XII. Write a proposal in not more than 150 words, stating the steps you would take to make it a success. [10]

Question 3

Answer subparts (i), (ii) and (iii).

- (i) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each of them in brackets. Make other changes that may be necessary, but do not change the meaning of each sentence. [5]
- (a) My grandmother said to me, “Where have you kept my reading glasses?”
(Begin: My grandmother asked ...)
- (b) The stream was so shallow that the children could wade across it.
(Use: enough)
- (c) The new bridge is stronger than the old one.
(Begin: The old bridge ...)
- (d) Although the tickets were expensive, the hall was full.
(Begin: In spite of ...)
- (e) Nikhil would rather walk to school than take the crowded bus.
(Use: prefer)
- (ii) Replace the INCORRECT underlined words to make the following sentences meaningful and grammatically correct. Do not copy the sentences. [5]
- (a) Everyone says that little Anu takes over her grandmother; she has the same laugh.
- (b) When the founder retired, his daughter took after the running of the company.
- (c) I ran over an old classmate at the railway station yesterday.
- (d) We had run into of milk, so I went to the shop before breakfast.
- (e) Please hold off for a moment while I connect you to the manager.
- (f) An overturned lorry on the highway held us on for nearly two hours.
- (g) The residents could no longer put up to the noise from the construction site.
- (h) The firemen worked through the night to put off the blaze.
- (i) The new principal brought out several changes in the school timetable.
- (j) My grandparents brought me about after my parents moved abroad.

- (iii) Fill in the blanks in the passage given below with the appropriate form of the verb given in brackets. Do not write the passage but write the verbs in the correct order. [5]

By late afternoon every fishing boat _____ (1) (return) to the harbour, for the old men of the village _____ (2) (warn) everyone that a storm was coming. At dusk the sky over the sea _____ (3) (turn) the colour of a bruise. A cold wind began _____ (4) (blow) from the south, _____ (5) (whip) the waves into white foam, and the gulls wheeled overhead, _____ (6) (scream), before they vanished inland. Down on the shore, the last fishermen hurried to drag their nets above the line of the tide.

When the first drops fell, they were as heavy as coins. Within minutes the rain _____ (7) (drive) across the beach in grey sheets, and the palm trees bent low as if they were _____ (8) (pray). Lightning split the darkness, and for an instant the whole bay _____ (9) (light) up like a stage. Then came the thunder, so loud that it seemed to _____ (10) (shake) the ground beneath our feet. We watched it all from my uncle's window, too excited to be afraid.

Question 4

Read the passage given below and answer the questions (i), (ii) and (iii) that follow.

(1) Gopal Das was the richest man in Kanakpur and the meanest. He lent money to farmers at an interest that doubled their debts every two years, and he kept every coin he received in a place that nobody in the village had ever discovered. He trusted no bank, no neighbour and no relative. He trusted, in fact, only his own eyes, and every night before he slept he went out with a lantern to make sure that his gold was where he had left it. 5

(2) The place was the hollow of an old tamarind tree at the far end of his courtyard, hidden behind a curtain of creepers. Into it, year after year, he had lowered a clay pot, and into the pot he had dropped gold coins, one by one, as other men drop seeds into the ground, except that nothing ever grew from them. 10

(3) His only servant was a thin boy named Raghu, who swept the courtyard, drew water and ate whatever was left on his master's plate. The boy had one friend in the world, a crow with a white patch on one wing, which he fed with crumbs every morning and which followed him about the courtyard, as a dog follows its master.

(4) One winter night, Gopal Das counted his coins and found that one was missing. The next night another had gone, and the night after that, two more. He did not sleep for a week. He searched the boy's bundle of clothes and questioned him until the child wept. At last, having found nothing, he turned Raghu out of the house without a single rupee of the wages he owed him, and told the whole village that the boy was a thief. 15 20

(5) The coins continued to vanish.

(6) Now, among those who owed money to Gopal Das was a widow named Kamala, who lived at the edge of the village in a hut with a roof of dried palm leaves. Three years earlier her husband had borrowed from the moneylender to buy seed, and when he died, the debt, swollen with interest, had fallen on her. Gopal Das held the deed to her small field, and he had announced that he would take the field at the next full moon unless she paid. 25

(7) On the morning of the full moon, Kamala appeared at his door and, to his

astonishment, counted out the whole sum in gold coins. Gopal Das examined each one, bit it, weighed it in his palm and found nothing wrong. Since the debt was paid, he was obliged, before three witnesses, to return the deed and sign a receipt. He did so with a sour face, wondering all the while where a penniless widow had found such wealth. 30

(8) He discovered the answer that very evening. Hiding behind the creepers with his lantern shuttered, he saw a crow with a white patch on its wing slip into the hollow of the tamarind tree and come out with something bright in its beak. He followed it, stumbling across the fields, all the way to the edge of the village, where it flew down onto a roof of dried palm leaves, in which it had built its nest, and dropped the coin among the others it had hidden there. 35

(9) Kamala, it turned out, had been finding gold coins among the leaves of her roof for months. She had believed them to be a gift from the gods, sent to save her field, and she had used them for nothing but the repayment of her debt. 40

(10) Gopal Das stood outside her hut and shouted until half the village had gathered. The coins were his, he said; the crow had stolen them; the debt was not paid at all. But the headman reminded him, politely, that the moneylender had examined every coin himself and signed a receipt before witnesses. And if the crow was the thief, the headman added, then surely a certain boy had been wrongly accused, and was owed his wages as well as an apology. 45

(11) Gopal Das paid Raghu's wages the next morning. It was the only money he had ever parted with in front of the whole village, and he did it with a face like thunder. The crow, which had missed its breakfast since the boy was sent away, was soon seen on the roof of Kamala's hut, where Raghu now helped in the field and saved the best crumbs for his friend. 50

(Adapted from: The Moneylender's Crow, an original story written for this sample paper)

(i)(a) Find a single word from the passage that will exactly replace the underlined word or words in the following sentences. [3]

- (1) To the great surprise of her teachers, the quiet girl won the debate.
- (2) As a guest, he felt bound by duty to praise the food, although it was cold.
- (3) The river, greatly increased in size by a week of rain, flooded the lower town.

- (b) For each of the words given below, choose the correct sentence that uses the same word unchanged in spelling, but with a different meaning from that which it carries in the passage. [3]
- (1) **deed** (line 26)
- (A) The lawyer kept the deed of the house in his safe.
 - (B) Helping the injured stranger was a truly kind deed.
 - (C) She signed the deed of sale in front of two witnesses.
 - (D) The old land was deeded to the village school.
- (2) **bit** (line 30)
- (A) The dog bit the postman on the ankle.
 - (B) Please wait a bit; the doctor will see you soon.
 - (C) The medicine had a bitter taste.
 - (D) He bit into the apple with a loud crunch.
- (3) **field** (line 26)
- (A) The farmer ploughed his field before the rains.
 - (B) The fielder caught the ball near the boundary.
 - (C) Cattle were grazing in the field behind the school.
 - (D) Marine biology is her chosen field of study.
- (ii) Answer the following questions as briefly as possible in your own words.
- (a) Why did Gopal Das turn Raghu out of his house? [2]
- (b) Give two examples from the passage to show that Gopal Das was both mean and mistrustful. [2]
- (c) In your opinion, was the headman's judgement fair? Give a reason for your answer. [2]
- (iii) Summarise the events that led to Kamala's debt being repaid and the truth about the missing coins coming out (paragraphs 6 to 10). You are required to write the summary in the **grid form** in about 100 words. The use of abbreviations and contractions will not be accepted. Failure to keep within the word limit will be penalised. [8]
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